



TOWERING BEAUTY

In May 2022, Louis Vuitton named Deepika Padukone as its latest global brand ambassador, the first Indian to hold the post

Several global luxury brands have roped in Indian actors as brand ambassadors to leverage their cultural clout and widespread popularity to connect with local customers

adds. “Their substantial digital presence further enhances their ability to engage with a broader and more global audience.”

Luxury brands are also expanding their footprint in India. Gucci opened its fifth store at Jio World Plaza and Louis Vuitton its fourth. Bulgari, too, has opened its second store at the mall after the one in Delhi. Waiting in the wings is the 125-year-old, Paris-based Galeries Lafayette. It will be the first European department store of its kind to enter India; it will open a branch in Mumbai next year, and then one in Delhi. Showcasing more than 200 international and local brands across fashion, lifestyle and food, the new venture is in partnership with Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail Ltd (ABFRL).

THE INDIAN LUXURY MARKET

Why are global brands flocking to India when the luxury market here is tiny compared to those like China? Per market research firm Euromonitor International, the luxury goods market in India is expected to grow to ₹82,186 crore by 2027 from ₹53,561 crore in 2022. “Thanks to domestic luxury shopping, Indian consumers’ spend on personal luxury goods has continued to grow year on year since 2020 to reach \$3.2 billion (around ₹26,648 crore) by 2023,” says Fflur Roberts, Head of Luxury Goods at Euromonitor International. “This trajectory is set to continue over the short to medium term, albeit at a slower pace, to reach \$4.3 billion (around ₹35,808 crore) by 2028, spurred on by a number of local factors, including better shopping options.”